AI Orchestrator

Running ads with the AI agent

Test guide for every pathway from setup to publish and monitoring, plus a prompt library for users

Short answer. Yes, the AI agent can create and publish an ad from a prompt, with one rule that is always enforced: **a person approves before money is spent.**

• **Meta (Facebook, Instagram):** the whole flow can be done in Command Chat. You can draft, validate, publish, pause, resume, change the budget and read results. The publish and budget steps wait for the owner to click **Approve**.
• **TikTok, Google Ads, YouTube, LinkedIn, X, Snapchat, Pinterest:** the agent builds the complete campaign from a prompt (plan, targeting, copy, images). A person then clicks **Publish** on the review page. Publishing these from chat isn't built yet.
• Campaigns made with "Create with AI" **never publish by themselves**. This was a deliberate product decision.

Current status (2026-10-02). Every pathway in this guide passed automated checks against the live database with the ad platforms **simulated**. None has run against a real ad platform yet. Start with Pathway 0 (simulated), then Pathway 1 with a Meta **sandbox** ad account (SPEC-BE-073), and only then spend real money with a small budget.

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A. What the AI agent can do

The software has two AI entry points for ads. Both end up as ordinary campaigns that you can open and edit in the manual builder.

Entry point	Where	What it does	Can it publish?
Command Chat	Chat page	Turns one message into a plan of steps (show, draft, publish, pause, budget, workflow). Read and draft steps run at once; other steps wait for approval.	Meta only: **yes**, after the owner approves. Other platforms: no, but it can start an AI campaign for them.
Create with AI (AI Ad Autopilot)	Campaigns → + New campaign → Create with AI, or from chat	Runs context → plan → targeting → copy → visuals → safety check → builds drafts on 1 to 3 platforms.	**Never by itself.** It stops at "Ready for review". A person clicks Publish or Publish paused.

Who must approve what (Command Chat)

Step type	Examples	Rule
Read	Show campaigns, show results	Runs immediately (viewer and up).
Draft	Create Meta draft, Create with AI, generate ad copy	Runs immediately. Nothing goes live.
Change	Pause on Meta, workflows, notify owner	Needs a manager or higher, other than the person who asked. The owner's own command approves itself.
Spend	Publish to Meta, resume on Meta, change Meta budget, launch campaign	**Always needs an explicit owner approval**, even when the owner asked.

A second money guard applies to every launch: when the company's daily spend would go over the **daily ad cap**, a non-owner's launch becomes an approval item that only the owner can approve.

What the agent can do, platform by platform

Task	Meta	TikTok, Google, YouTube, LinkedIn, X, Snapchat, Pinterest
Build a full campaign from a prompt	Yes (chat or Create with AI)	Yes (Create with AI, also started from chat)
Generate images	Yes, with an OpenAI or Gemini key, or use product photos	Same; TikTok and YouTube need your own video
Validate with the platform	Yes (chat or builder)	Yes (builder / review page)
Publish	Chat (owner approves) or Publish button	Publish button only
Pause / resume	Chat or buttons	Buttons
Change budget on a live campaign	Chat (owner approves)	Edit in the builder
Read results (spend, CTR, ROAS, conversions)	Chat and Analytics	Analytics
Automatic alerts on results	Workflows ("Ad metric crosses a threshold")	Same trigger fires after each results import

Not available from chat yet: scheduling organic social posts, sending messages to customers, and changing the budget of non-Meta campaigns. The agent tells you this instead of pretending.

B. Before you start

API keys alone aren't enough: each ad platform also needs an account with a payment method and approved API access. Work through this list once.

#	Item	Where	Needed for
1	Owner account and company (sign up)	/signup	Everything
2	Company country, currency, timezone	Settings → Organization	Budgets and reports
3	**AI model key** (Claude, GPT or Gemini). An OpenAI or Gemini key also enables image generation.	Settings → AI Models (Save & test)	Chat plans, Create with AI
4	Brand voice (tone, style) and forbidden words	Settings → Brand	AI copy and safety check
5	Products with price, image and URL	E-Commerce	Product ads, “use product photos”
6	Daily ad cap	Settings → Organization	Spend approvals
7	**Meta:** developer app + META_APP_ID, META_APP_SECRET, META_LOGIN_CONFIG_ID in backend/.env; Business Manager, ad account with payment method, Facebook Page	Meta developers site, then Integrations → Connect with Facebook	Meta ads
8	**Other platforms:** approved API access + tokens: Google developer token (Basic access), TikTok Marketing API app, LinkedIn Advertising API, X Ads API, Snapchat Marketing API, Pinterest Ads Standard access	Integrations (paste credentials, Test)	Those platforms
9	Users with roles: one owner, at least one manager (to test approvals)	Settings → Users	Pathway 7

Meta development mode: only people with a role on your Meta app can connect. To let other companies connect, Meta needs Business Verification and App Review (Advanced Access), which takes weeks. The OAuth redirect must be `{FRONTEND_BASE_URL}/integrations/meta/callback`; localhost works only in development mode.

C. Test pathways

Run them in order. Tick each box only when you saw the expected result. Use a **test company**, not your real one, and keep budgets tiny until Pathway 1 has passed.

Pathway 0: Rehearsal with simulated platforms (no real accounts, no money)

#	Do this	You should see	Done
1	In backend/.env set `META_FAKE_TRANSPORT=true` (and optionally `LLM_PROVIDER=fixture`). APP_ENV must not be production. Restart the backend.	Backend starts. These fakes are refused in production.	☐
2	Run Pathways 3 to 10 below.	Every platform answers from built-in fixtures; IDs look real but nothing leaves your computer.	☐
3	Set `META_FAKE_TRANSPORT=false` again and restart.	Real platform calls from now on.	☐

Pathway 1: Connect Meta (real, start with a sandbox ad account)

#	Do this	You should see	Done
1	Integrations → Meta → **Connect with Facebook**.	Facebook login opens (if you get 503, the three META_ settings are missing).	☐
2	Log in, choose the business and approve.	You come back to the app with lists of ad accounts and Pages.	☐
3	Pick the ad account, Page, and optionally Instagram account and pixel. Save.	The Meta card shows **Connected**; the currency matches the ad account.	☐

Pathway 2: Connect the other platforms

#	Do this	You should see	Done
1	Integrations → each platform → paste the credentials → **Save & test**.	"Connected". Saved secrets show only masked.	☐
2	Campaigns → + New campaign.	The Ad Manager shows 8 cards; connected platforms are usable.	☐

Pathway 3: Manual Meta campaign (the baseline)

#	Do this	You should see	Done
1	Campaigns → + New campaign → Meta.	The Meta builder opens with campaign, ad set and ad levels.	☐
2	Campaign: name, objective (e.g. Traffic), budget.	Saved as draft.	☐
3	Ad set: countries, age, gender, placements, schedule.	Reach estimate appears.	☐
4	Ad: upload an image (JPG/PNG up to 30 MB), primary text, headline, CTA, https destination URL.	Image shows as uploaded.	☐
5	**Validate**.	"OK", or each problem shown next to its field.	☐
6	**Preview**; switch Facebook feed / Instagram / Stories.	Meta's real preview renders.	☐
7	**Publish paused** first.	Status Paused; IDs and an Ads Manager link appear. Check it in Meta Ads Manager.	☐
8	**Resume**, then **Pause**.	Status follows on both the app and Meta.	☐

Pathway 4: Manual campaign on another platform

#	Do this	You should see	Done
1	+ New campaign → choose e.g. TikTok.	Platform builder opens (campaign → ad groups → ads).	☐

#	Do this	You should see	Done
2	Fill in targeting, budget, media (TikTok/YouTube: upload your video).	Draft saved.	☐
3	Validate → Publish paused → Resume → Pause.	Same as Pathway 3. Any failure rolls back everything already created.	☐

Pathway 5: Create with AI (prompt → review → publish)

#	Do this	You should see	Done
1	+ New campaign → **Create with AI**.	Form: prompt, platforms (1 to 3), goal, budget, dates, landing page, products, visuals.	☐
2	Paste a prompt from Part E, set budget and https landing page, choose "Generate with AI" or product photos. Start.	Progress through Context → Plan → Targeting → Copy → Visuals → Safety.	☐
3	If it asks a question, answer it.	The run continues (status was "needs input").	☐
4	Review page: check plan, audiences, copy, images and the safety report.	**Ready for review.** Nothing is live.	☐
5	Click any draft to open it in the builder and edit.	Same builder as Pathways 3 and 4.	☐
6	Tick **acknowledge warnings** if any, then **Publish paused**.	Campaign created on the platform, paused. Errors block publishing.	☐
7	Try a forbidden word or a fake discount in the prompt.	Safety repairs it, or blocks publishing with the reason.	☐

Pathway 6: Command Chat end to end (Meta)

#	Do this	You should see	Done
1	Chat: prompt E2 #1 (draft).	A plan card with one draft step runs; link to the draft.	☐
2	Open the draft, upload an image (a chat-made Meta draft has no media yet).	The missing list is empty.	☐
3	Chat: "Validate campaign <name>".	Validation result in the reply.	☐
4	Chat: "Publish campaign <name> to Meta as paused".	Spend step waits: **Approve (owner)**.	☐
5	As owner, click **Approve**.	It runs in the background; summary reply with the Meta link.	☐
6	Chat: "Resume it", then "Pause it", then "Set its daily budget to 800".	Resume and budget need owner approval; pause needs manager approval.	☐

Pathway 7: Approvals and the spend cap

#	Do this	You should see	Done
1	Set a low daily ad cap. Log in as a **manager**.	—	☐
2	Manager publishes a campaign over the cap (builder, review page or chat).	No platform call; an approval item is created for the owner.	☐
3	Owner opens approvals → **Approve**.	The campaign publishes. Reject leaves it as a draft.	☐
4	A viewer tries to publish.	Refused (403).	☐

Pathway 8: Failure and safety checks

#	Do this	You should see	Done
1	Publish with a missing destination URL / no Page / no image.	Blocked with a message naming what is missing (422).	☐
2	Disconnect the platform, then publish.	409 "Connect … in Integrations".	☐

#	Do this	You should see	Done
3	Revoke the app in Meta Business settings, then call anything.	Integration shows **expired**; reconnect.	☐
4	Check the backend log for your tokens.	No token or secret appears.	☐

Pathway 9: Results import and monitoring

#	Do this	You should see	Done
1	After the campaign has run a few hours: Analytics → **Sync now**.	Spend, impressions, clicks, CTR, conversions, ROAS (5-minute throttle).	☐
2	Wait for the automatic import (every 3 hours).	Last 3 days are re-imported each time.	☐
3	Chat: prompt E5 #1.	Results summary in chat.	☐
4	Campaign list and Marketing page.	Spent, CTR, ROAS, platform status (e.g. In review, Disapproved, Active).	☐

Pathway 10: Automatic alerts (workflows)

#	Do this	You should see	Done
1	Chat: prompt E6 #1 (alert when ROAS drops).	A workflow is saved **disabled**; review it in Workflows.	☐
2	Turn it on (chat "Turn on that workflow" or the toggle).	Enabled. Workflows that pause or spend need owner approval.	☐
3	After the next results import crosses the threshold.	A notification appears for the owner.	☐

Pathway 11: Clean up

#	Do this	You should see	Done
1	Pause or delete test campaigns in each platform's own Ads Manager.	Nothing delivering.	☐
2	Disconnect test integrations; delete the test company if no longer needed.	No test data left.	☐

D. Monitoring: where to look

What	Where	How fresh
Platform status (In review, Disapproved, Active, With issues) and rejection reasons	Campaign builder and campaign list	Read from the platform on open (cached 60 s)
Spend, impressions, clicks, CTR, conversions, ROAS per day	Analytics (7d / 30d / 90d)	Every 3 h, or Sync now
Today's ad spend, active campaigns, ROAS	Dashboard and Marketing	Same import
Approvals waiting	Chat → approvals panel	Live
Who did what (published, paused, failed)	Activity feed / audit log	Live
Alerts	Workflows with the “Ad metric crosses a threshold” trigger → notify owner / create task	After each import
Quick answers	Command Chat (prompts in E5)	On request

Metrics with no data show as empty, never as an estimate. A brand-new or sandbox campaign often has no results; that's expected.

E. Prompt library

How to write a good ad prompt. Include: what you sell, who it's for, where (countries or cities), the goal, the budget and whether it's daily or total, the dates, the landing page (must start with https://), and which platforms. Mention a discount only if it's really in your product prices: the safety check compares them.

Safety built in. The prompt is treated as data. Text like “ignore the rules” or “publish now” inside a prompt can't change the budget, platforms or approvals. Budget is in your company currency. Replace everything in <angle brackets> with your own details.

E1. Create a full campaign with AI (Command Chat or the Create with AI box)

Required: 1 to 3 platforms, a budget, an https landing page. The agent asks for anything missing. From chat, the run starts 1 hour later and lasts 7 days; set other dates on the Create with AI form or in the builder.

1	`Create an AI campaign on Meta and TikTok for our Eid kurta collection, aimed at young professionals aged 22-35 in Dhaka and Chattogram. Goal: sales. Total budget 5000 for 7 days. Landing page https://<yourshop>/eid. Feature SKUs KURTA-01 and KURTA-02 and generate the images.`	Multi-platform sales campaign; stops at review.
2	`Create an AI campaign on Google to bring traffic to https://<yourshop>/winter-sale for people in Bangladesh searching for winter jackets. Daily budget 600, run 14 days.`	Search/Demand Gen traffic campaign.
3	`Create an AI lead campaign on LinkedIn for HR managers at companies with 50+ employees in Singapore and Malaysia, offering a free payroll demo. Total budget 1500, 10 days, landing page https://<site>/demo.`	B2B leads.
4	`Create an AI awareness campaign on Meta, TikTok and Snapchat for the launch of our new coffee shop in Gulshan, Dhaka, for ages 18-30 within the city. Total budget 3000 over 5 days. Landing page https://<site>/opening. Use product photos.`	Local awareness, 3 platforms (the max).
5	`Create an AI campaign on Pinterest for home decor lovers in the US and Canada, women 25-45, showing our handmade jute rugs. Goal: traffic. Daily budget 40, 30 days, landing page https://<shop>/rugs.`	Visual product discovery.
6	`Create an AI app-install campaign on Meta and Google for our food delivery app in Dhaka, ages 18-40. Daily budget 1000 for 10 days. Landing page https://<site>/app.`	Goal: app.
7	`Create an AI campaign on YouTube for our online English course, for students 17-25 in Bangladesh and Nepal. Goal: awareness. Total budget 4000 over 14 days. Landing page https://<site>/course. I will upload the video in the builder.`	Video platform: video comes from you.
8	`Create an AI campaign on X for our tech conference tickets, people interested in startups and AI in India. Goal: sales. Total budget 2500, 7 days, https://<site>/tickets.`	Event ticket sales.

E2. Meta campaign drafts with exact settings (Command Chat)

Objectives: awareness, traffic, engagement, leads, app_promotion, sales. CTAs: SHOP_NOW, LEARN_MORE, SIGN_UP, ORDER_NOW, CONTACT_US, BOOK_NOW, GET_OFFER. Upload an image in the builder before publishing.

1	`Create a Meta campaign draft “Eid Sale - Traffic”: objective traffic, daily budget 500 for 7 days starting tomorrow, Bangladesh, ages 20-40, all genders, Facebook and Instagram, destination https://<shop>/eid, headline “Eid collection is here”, call to action SHOP_NOW.`	Full campaign, ad set and ad draft.

2	`Create a Meta sales campaign draft for SKU SHOE-07, lifetime budget 8000 for 14 days, India and Bangladesh, ages 18-35, men, destination https://<shop>/shoe-07, CTA ORDER_NOW.`	Sales uses your pixel.
3	`Create a Meta leads campaign draft “Free consultation”: daily budget 300 for 10 days, United Arab Emirates, ages 25-55, destination https://<site>/consult, CTA SIGN_UP.`	Leads objective.
4	`Create a Meta awareness draft for our brand in Nepal, daily budget 200 for 5 days, ages 18-65, Facebook only, destination https://<site>, CTA LEARN_MORE.`	Awareness.
5	`Create a Meta engagement draft for our new menu, daily budget 150 for 3 days, Dhaka, ages 18-45, Instagram, destination https://<site>/menu, CTA BOOK_NOW.`	Engagement.

E3. Check, preview and publish (Command Chat)

For campaigns made with Create with AI, publish from their review page so warnings are acknowledged there.

1	`Validate campaign “Eid Sale - Traffic”.`	Local + Meta validation.
2	`Publish campaign “Eid Sale - Traffic” to Meta as paused.`	Owner approval, then created paused.
3	`Publish campaign “Eid Sale - Traffic” to Meta and make it active.`	Owner approval; goes live.
4	`Create a Meta traffic draft for SKU KURTA-01 with daily budget 400 for 7 days in Bangladesh, ages 20-35, destination https://<shop>/kurta-01, then validate it.`	Two steps in one message.
5	`Launch campaign “Spring Email Promo”.`	For wizard drafts on non-Meta channels (internal); owner approval.

E4. Control running ads (Command Chat)

Refer to campaigns by name (the agent sees your 30 most recent). Pause single ad sets or ads with the buttons in the builder.

1	`Pause campaign “Eid Sale - Traffic” on Meta.`	Change step (manager approval).
2	`Resume campaign “Eid Sale - Traffic”.`	Spend step (owner approval).
3	`Change the daily budget of “Eid Sale - Traffic” to 800.`	Owner approval.
4	`Set a lifetime budget of 12000 on campaign “Winter Shoes”.`	Lifetime budget.

E5. Monitor results (Command Chat)

Ranges: 7d, 30d, 90d, lifetime. Results come from the platform import (every 3 hours or Sync now).

1	`Show results for all my campaigns in the last 7 days.`	Spend, CTR, ROAS, conversions.
2	`How is “Eid Sale - Traffic” doing over the last 30 days?`	One campaign.
3	`Show lifetime results for campaign “Winter Shoes”.`	Lifetime range.
4	`Show all campaigns with their status, budget and spend.`	Campaign list.
5	`Which of my campaigns has the best ROAS this week? Show results for the last 7 days.`	Compare from the results table.

E6. Automatic monitoring with workflows (Command Chat)

1	`Create a workflow: when any ad campaign's ROAS drops below 1.5, notify the owner.`	Saved disabled; enable it after review.
2	`Create a workflow: when a campaign's CTR falls below 0.8%, create a task for managers to refresh the creative.`	Task for managers.

3	`Create a workflow: when daily spend of a campaign goes above 2000, notify the owner.`	Overspend alert.
4	`Create a workflow that every Monday at 9am notifies the owner to review last week's ad results.`	Scheduled reminder.
5	`Create a workflow: when a campaign's ROAS is below 1, notify the owner and create a task for managers to review its budget.`	Several actions.
6	`Turn on the workflow “ROAS drop alert”.`	Enable (owner approval if it spends).
7	`Show my workflows.`	List with runs in the last 7 days.

E7. Ad copy only (nothing is published)

1	`Write ad copy for Instagram to get traffic to our new summer sandals, SKU SANDAL-03, fun and young tone.`	Creative drafts.
2	`Generate Facebook ad copy for awareness of our free delivery week in Dhaka.`	Creative drafts.
3	`Write 3 TikTok captions for conversions on our protein bars.`	Creative drafts.

E8. Combined prompts (one message, several steps)

1	`Show my low-stock products, then create an AI campaign on Meta for the ones with plenty of stock, total budget 3000 for 7 days, landing page https://<shop>/deals.`	Read + draft.
2	`Pause campaign “Winter Shoes” on Meta and notify the owner that it was paused because the season ended.`	Change + notify.
3	`Show results for the last 7 days and create a workflow that alerts me when ROAS drops below 2.`	Read + workflow.

What the agent will say no to

- Publishing a Create with AI campaign without a person clicking Publish.
- Spending (publish, resume, budget) without the owner's approval.
- Scheduling organic social posts and messaging customers: not connected yet.
- Changing the budget of a non-Meta campaign from chat: edit it in the builder.
- Publishing TikTok, Google, YouTube, LinkedIn, X, Snapchat or Pinterest from chat: use the Publish button.
- Inventing a discount that isn't in your product prices (the safety check blocks it).

F. Troubleshooting

Message or code	Meaning	Fix
503 on Connect with Facebook	Meta app settings missing	Add META_APP_ID, META_APP_SECRET, META_LOGIN_CONFIG_ID; restart backend
409 “Connect … in Integrations”	Platform not connected	Pathway 1 or 2
Integration shows expired	Token revoked or expired (Meta code 190)	Reconnect
422 “Upload an image” / “Upload a video”	Ad has no media	Upload in the builder (TikTok/YouTube need your video)
422 “Choose a Facebook Page”	No Page selected	Integrations → Meta → choose Page
422 missing destination / pixel / Instagram account	Required asset missing for this objective or placement	Add it or change the objective/placement
502 with the platform's message	The platform refused; everything created was rolled back	Fix the field named and publish again
503 “rate-limiting this account”	Too many calls	Wait a few minutes
Chat says AI is unavailable	No working AI model key	Settings → AI Models → Save & test
“Generate with AI” greyed out	No OpenAI or Gemini key for images	Add one, or use product photos / builder
Run stuck at needs input	The agent asked a question	Answer it on the run page
Publish blocked by safety	Forbidden word, policy risk or false discount	Edit the copy in the builder, then publish
Results empty	No import yet, or sandbox/new campaign	Sync now; wait for delivery
Approval waiting	Spend step or over the daily cap	Owner clicks Approve

Reference specs: SPEC-BE-054/055/056 (Meta), 059 (Command Chat), 060 (workflows), 062 to 068 (other platforms), 069/070 (AI Ad Autopilot), 073 (live Meta sandbox run).